

B.V.V. Sangha's
BASAVESHWAR ENGINEERING COLLEGE
BAGALKOTE-587102



2025-26

DEPARTMENT OF INFORMATION SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

MINI-PROJECT (21UIS513P)

***Report
on***

“FOOD WASTAGE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM”

Project Guide

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DEPARTMENT OF INFORMATION SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project work entitled “FOOD WASTEAGE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM” is a bonafide work carried out by “Sujay Joshi, Shreya Fakirapur, Vandana Kadalagi” of Department of Information Science and Engineering, Basaveshwar Engineering College, Bagalkote, affiliated to VTU Belagavi, during the academic year 2025-26, the project report has been approved as it satisfies the academic requirements in respect of mini-project work.

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Declaration

We hereby declare that the project work entitled “FOOD WASTEAGE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM” submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the degree of Bachelor of Engineering in Information Science and Engineering to the Basaveshwar Engineering College has been carried out by us under the guidance of Prof. M. R .Patil, Professor, Information Science and Engineering during the academic year [2025–2026].

We also declare that this project work is original and has not been submitted to any other university or institution for the award of any degree or diploma.

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Abstract

Food waste is a critical concern with significant social, environmental, and economic repercussions. Large quantities of edible food are discarded daily, even as millions struggle with hunger and malnutrition. Addressing this gap requires not only social awareness but also practical technological interventions that enable surplus food to reach those in need efficiently. The Food Waste Management System project was developed in response to this challenge, aiming to connect food donors with beneficiaries through an accessible and robust online platform.

This web-based application provides a streamlined interface for donors—including households, restaurants, and events—to easily register surplus food they wish to donate. Registered users can submit details of available food donations, which are then processed and managed by system administrators. Admins oversee donation requests, manage user accounts, and coordinate with delivery agents to ensure the collection and fair distribution of food to non-profit organizations, shelters, or individuals who require assistance.

The platform uses PHP on the backend and MySQL for data management, ensuring secure user authentication, real-time status updates, and centralized tracking of all operations. Delivery agents are assigned donation pickups and drop-offs, updating the system at each step to maintain transparency and traceability. By offering distinct interfaces and workflows for users, admins, and delivery staff, the solution minimizes operational errors and optimizes the end-to-end donation process.

Overall, this project demonstrates how technology can be leveraged to combat the dual problems of food wastage and hunger. It provides a practical, scalable model for communities to adopt, harnessing the power of web-based systems to facilitate social good. The Food Waste Management System contributes not only to efficient resource utilization but also supports sustainability and social welfare in the broader context.

Table of Contents

S.No.	Table of Contents	Page No.
1	Chapter 1: Introduction 1.1. Motivation 1.2. Objectives 1.3. Scope of project 1.4 Literature Survey	1-5
2	Chapter 2: Problem Formulation 2.1. Introduction 2.2. Present Statement 2.3. Proposed Statement 2.4 Problem Statement	6-7
3	Chapter 3: Requirements 3.1. Functional Requirements 3.2. Non-Functional Requirements 3.3. Hardware and Software Requirements	8-9
4	Chapter 4: Design 4.1. Architecture 4.2. Detailed Design 4.2.1. Use Case Diagram 4.2.2. Class Diagram 4.2.3. Sequence Diagram	10-13
5	Chapter 5: Implementation 5.1. Flowchart 5.2. Implementation of the project 5.2.1. Algorithms	14-18
6	Chapter 6: Testing 6.1. Different steps of Testing 6.2. Test Cases	19-21

continued.....

S.No.	Table of Contents	Page No.
7	Chapter7: Results and Discussions 7.1. Snapshots	22-25
8	Chapter 8: Conclusion and Scope for Future 8.1. Conclusion 8.2. Future Scope	26
9	References	27
10	Appendices Appendix-A Appendix-B Appendix-C Appendix-D Appendix-E	28-29

List of Figures

S.No	Fig No .	Title	Page No.
1	Fig.4.1.1	Architecture	10
2	Fig.4.2.1	Detailed Design	10
3	Fig.4.2.1.1	Use Case Diagram	11
4	Fig.4.2.2.1	Class Diagram	12
5	Fig.4.2.3.1	Sequence Diagram	13
6	Fig.5.1.1	Flowchart	14
7	Fig.7.1.1	Login Page	22
8	Fig.7.1.2	User Login Page	22
9	Fig.7.1.3	Admin Page	23
10	Fig.7.1.4	Home Page	23
11	Fig.7.1.5	About Us Page	23
12	Fig.7.1.6	Contact Us Page	24
13	Fig.7.1.7	Admin Register Page	24
14	Fig.7.1.8	Delivery Reg Page	25

Chapter 1. Introduction

Food waste remains one of the most pressing concerns facing societies around the world, particularly in developing nations where hunger and malnutrition persist alongside large amounts of wasted edible food. Every year, significant quantities of surplus food are discarded by households, restaurants, and events, even while many people live in food insecurity. This mismatch between surplus and need has prompted communities and innovators to seek effective solutions for redirecting food that would otherwise go to waste.

The Food Waste Management System addresses this challenge by leveraging web technology to streamline the collection, management, and redistribution of surplus food. The system provides distinct interfaces for donors, administrators, and delivery personnel, ensuring organized and secure participation from all stakeholders. Donors can easily register food donations using a user-friendly online platform, while administrators coordinate the verification, tracking, and assignment of resources. Delivery agents facilitate the timely pickup and drop-off of food to partnering organizations or individuals in need.

1.1 Motivation

Food waste is a growing challenge that has far-reaching socioeconomic and environmental consequences. Despite significant advancements in agriculture and food production, millions of people continue to suffer from hunger and undernourishment, while large volumes of edible food are discarded at various stages of the supply chain. This mismatch between abundance and scarcity inspired the creation of a technology-driven solution, one that could harness the power of web platforms to connect donors and distributors and ensure surplus food benefits those who need it most.

The motivation behind developing this system is rooted in the desire to make food redistribution both practical and scalable. By leveraging simple, accessible technology, the project aims not only to reduce landfill-bound waste and mitigate environmental harm but also to foster social responsibility and community engagement. Through a streamlined platform, individuals and organizations are empowered to participate in food donation, enabling efficient collection, tracking, and delivery processes—all contributing to a more sustainable and equitable society.

1.2 Objectives

- To develop an efficient web-based platform for managing and redistributing surplus food.
- To provide separate access and authentication for donors, admins, and delivery personnel.
- To enable donors to easily register and notify surplus food availability.
- To facilitate admins in verifying donations, managing users, and coordinating food distribution.
- To streamline the delivery process by assigning pickups and drop-offs to delivery agents.
- To reduce food wastage and support social welfare by connecting surplus food to those in need

1.3 Scope of project

- The system covers user registration and distinct access for donors, admins, and delivery agents.
- Donors can submit food donation details via the web platform, making surplus food available for collection.
- Admins manage the verification, approval, and tracking of food donations and user accounts.
- Delivery agents receive assigned pickup and delivery tasks with real-time updates for efficient logistics.
- The platform maintains a centralized database for all transactions, user profiles, donation records, and delivery statuses.

1.4 Literature Survey

[1] A. Sharma and P. Singh, “Food Waste Management: A Comprehensive Review,” Environmental Science and Pollution Research, Springer,2023

Key Findings:-

The study proposes a novel neural network-based approach, supported by a gallium arsenide processing schema, to accurately predict waste generation and composition during the vermicomposting process. This approach demonstrated a high average prediction accuracy of 91.32%, outperforming other existing neural network methods, and effectively improved waste separation efficiency.

[2] R. Gupta et al., “Insights into the Management of Food Waste in Developing Countries: With Special Reference to India,” Int. J. on Advanced Electrical and Computer Engineering,2025.

Key Findings:-

Urbanization, modernization, and rapid population growth in Indian cities have caused a steady increase in food waste generation, posing challenges for efficient waste management and public health concerns if not properly addressed.

[3] V. Mehta and D. Reddy, “Food Donation Management System with Real-Time User Data Tracking,” Int. J. of Research and Analytical Reviews,(IJRAR),2020.

Key Findings:-

The system includes features for donor registration, submission of excess food details including quantity and location, automated notifications to NGOs, and real-time tracking of food collection logistics to ensure efficient redistribution and reduce food waste.

[4] S. Nair and K. Deshmukh, “Barriers to Food Bank Adoption and Growth in India: A Hybrid DEMATEL–ANP Study,” *Socio-Economic Planning Sciences* (Elsevier), 2022.

Key Findings:-

Food banks in India are a relatively recent phenomenon, playing an important role in ensuring food security by recovering surplus food and redistributing it to economically poor and marginalized populations. Despite their potential, food banks in India face significant challenges including lack of planning and coordination, inadequate infrastructure, and limited human resources.

[5] L. Thomas and P. White, “Zero Hunger: A Comparative Review of Food Banks in the UK and India,” *Environmental Science and Pollution Research*, Springer, 2024.

Key Findings:-

The food bank system in India faces challenges such as volunteer recruitment and attracting sufficient donors. Strengthening this system requires robust data collection and analysis, which can guide improvements in the delivery, coordination, and organization of existing food bank networks in India.

[6] R. Das and M. Bose, “Food Waste in Indian Households: Status and Potential,” *Journal of Cleaner Production* (Elsevier), 2020.

Key Findings:-

To address this issue, the study suggests exploring alternative food consumption methods and strengthening family food culture, providing actionable insights for policymakers and planners to design effective strategies to reduce food waste in Indian households, thereby improving sustainability and food security.

India produces a substantial amount of food waste, estimated at 68.7 million tonnes annually, with an average of 50 kg wasted per person each year, predominantly originating from households due to factors like improper meal planning and undervaluing food.

[7] P. Suresh and J. Mathew, “Food Waste in Hospitality and Food Services: A Systematic Review,” *Science of the Total Environment*, 2023.

Key Findings:-

The review analyzes peer-reviewed research on food waste in the hospitality sector, covering themes from causes of waste generation, leftover handling, waste hotspots, to waste reduction strategies, offering a comprehensive thematic framework that guides future empirical research.

The study highlights methodological gaps, including the need for more robust research designs, greater geographic diversity, deeper exploration of demographic and behavioral influences, and stronger theoretical foundations to better understand and address food waste in hospitality settings

[8] H. Perera and S. Fernando, “A Circular Economy Approach to Food Security and Poverty,” Circular Economy and Sustainability (Springer), 2023.

Key Findings:-

The study identifies good practices from 54 food banks comprising FESBAL, analyzing their contributions across four sustainability dimensions: social, economic, environmental, and governance, consistent with the Principles for Responsible Investment in Agriculture and Food Systems (CFS-RAI).

Drawing on over 35 years of experience, the food banks demonstrate significant positive impacts on food security and sustainable development through collaborative social learning and a holistic approach rooted in community engagement and resource optimization.

[9] K. Rao et al., “Food Donation as a Strategy to Reduce Food Waste: A Stakeholder Study,” BMC / PMC Open Access Journal, 2023.

Key Findings:-

Businesses, particularly small organizations, face obstacles such as limited storage capacity, transportation challenges, and unavailability of pick-up services, which hinder their ability to donate surplus food. Additionally, requirements for sorting, labeling, and meeting donation standards add inconvenience and negatively affect donor attitudes.

[10] N. Sharma and R. Gupta, “Insights into the Management of Food Waste in Developing Countries,” Environmental Science and Pollution Research (Springer), 2022.

Key Findings:-

Up to one-third of food grown for human consumption is wasted globally, with India facing environmental and socio-economic consequences as food waste increases due to urbanization, modernization, and population growth.

Inefficient food waste management in Indian cities leads to environmental degradation and public health risks, calling for comprehensive strategies that include food waste characterization and improved handling techniques.

Purpose:

Provides a comprehensive review of recent developments in deep learning-based computer vision systems. **Techniques & Approaches:** Discusses various deep learning architectures, including CNNs, RNNs, and hybrid models, for tasks like image recognition, object detection, and video analysis. **Findings & Implications:** Highlights performance improvements, challenges (e.g., data requirements, computational cost), and future research directions in enhancing the accuracy and efficiency of deep vision systems.

Chapter 2. Problem Formulation

2.1 Introduction

In today's world, food wastage is a critical issue with significant social and environmental impacts. Despite the abundance of food production, a large portion is wasted before it reaches those in need. This inefficiency not only squanders valuable resources but also exacerbates hunger and poverty. Traditional food donation and redistribution efforts often face challenges such as lack of coordination, inefficient tracking, and limited accessibility for donors and recipients alike. The current systems fall short in addressing the growing demand for streamlined, technology-driven solutions that can minimize waste and maximize benefits.

To overcome these challenges, the proposed Food Waste Management System leverages digital technology to facilitate the effective collection, management, and distribution of surplus food. The system provides distinct interfaces for donors, administrators, and delivery personnel, enabling seamless coordination among all stakeholders. By automating key processes such as donation registration, verification, and assignment of delivery tasks, the platform ensures organized and transparent workflows. Additionally, real-time status updates and database-driven workflows enhance visibility and accountability at every step.

This approach aims to bridge the gap between food surplus and demand through a user-friendly, interactive platform that fosters responsible food sharing within communities. By harnessing web-based systems, the project intends to reduce food wastage, promote sustainability, and improve food security. Ultimately, the Food Waste Management System exemplifies how modern digital tools can be harnessed to create socially impactful and environmentally conscious solutions—transforming food waste from a problem into an opportunity for positive change.

2.2 Present System

Currently, food donation and redistribution efforts mostly rely on manual processes, disconnected communication channels, and paper-based record keeping. Donors interested in sharing surplus food typically have limited access to coordinated platforms, making it difficult to efficiently inform organizations or delivery personnel. Administrators face challenges in tracking donation requests, verifying food availability, and managing logistics without real-time data. Delivery agents often lack systematic approaches for organizing pickups and drop-offs, leading to delays and wastage.

The absence of centralized systems results in inefficiencies, delays, duplication of efforts, and miscommunication that undermine the potential impact of food donation programs. Limited scalability and lack of transparency make it challenging for stakeholders to monitor donation statuses or evaluate system performance accurately. These gaps ultimately reduce the effectiveness of food redistribution efforts and contribute to continuing food wastage despite the presence of willing donors and recipients.

To address these challenges, the present system seeks to incorporate a web-based platform that integrates donor registration, donation listing, admin verification, and delivery assignment into a seamless workflow. By digitalizing key functions and automating manual processes, the system aims to improve coordination among stakeholders, enhance data management, and enable transparent tracking from donation to delivery. This results in a more streamlined and impactful approach to reducing food waste and feeding those in need.

2.3 Proposed System

The proposed Food Waste Management System is a comprehensive web-based platform designed to tackle the challenges of food wastage through streamlined coordination between donors, administrators, and delivery agents. The system provides a user-friendly interface for donors to register surplus food donations, specifying details such as type, quantity, and pickup time. This digitized approach replaces manual, inefficient methods, making it easier for donors to contribute regularly and systematically.

Administrators play a crucial role in the system, equipped with tools to verify incoming donation requests, manage user accounts, and assign delivery tasks efficiently. The platform maintains real-time records of food donations, pickup schedules, and delivery statuses, leveraging a centralized MySQL database for accurate tracking and retrieval of information. This ensures transparency, accountability, and timely distribution of surplus food to beneficiaries, minimizing delays and wastage.

Delivery agents access the system through a dedicated interface that provides their assigned pickups and drop-offs. They update the status of each delivery, allowing administrators and donors to monitor progress. Automated notifications and status updates improve communication and logistic efficiency, enabling swift responses to changing conditions and urgent requests.

Overall, the proposed system aims to create an interconnected ecosystem where food surplus is effectively matched with demand, reducing environmental impact and supporting social welfare. By digitalizing and automating the donation lifecycle—from registration through delivery—the platform sets the foundation for scalable community-driven food waste management, empowering stakeholders and fostering sustainability.

2.4 Problem Statement

Food wastage is a major issue causing economic loss, environmental damage, and worsening hunger. Existing food donation methods lack coordination, proper tracking, and real-time updates, resulting in inefficiencies and missed opportunities to help those in need. This project aims to develop a digital system that connects donors, administrators, and delivery agents to streamline food donations and ensure surplus food reaches beneficiaries efficiently and transparently.

Chapter 3. Requirements

3.1 Functional Requirements

The system must enable users (donors, administrators, and delivery agents) to register and authenticate securely, with distinct access rights and profiles. Donors should be able to submit detailed food donation requests, which administrators can verify, approve, and assign to delivery agents. Delivery personnel must receive, update, and track assigned pickup and drop-off tasks in real-time, allowing seamless communication and status monitoring. The platform should maintain a centralized database for storing all user data, donation details, and delivery records while providing timely notifications and reports. It must ensure accuracy, transparency, and data security throughout the donation and delivery lifecycle to achieve efficient food redistribution and waste reduction.

3.2 Non-Functional Requirement

The system is designed to be highly reliable and available, ensuring uninterrupted access to users at all times, including donors, admins, and delivery agents. It must maintain data integrity and security by employing robust authentication and authorization mechanisms to protect sensitive information and prevent unauthorized access. Scalability is a key consideration, allowing the system to handle increasing numbers of users and transactions without degradation in performance.

Usability is another critical factor, with the platform featuring an intuitive, user-friendly interface to accommodate users of varying technical proficiency. Performance requirements mandate low response times and swift processing of requests, ensuring smooth interactions even during peak usage. The system should also be maintainable, with easily identifiable components and modular design to facilitate future enhancements, troubleshooting, and updates.

Furthermore, the application must be accessible over the internet and compatible with common web browsers and devices. It should adhere to relevant legal and regulatory requirements regarding data privacy and user consent. Together, these non-functional requirements ensure that the Food Waste Management System operates efficiently, securely, and effectively in a real-world deployment environment.

3.3 Hardware and Software Requirements

Hardware Requirements

The Food Waste Management System requires a reliable web server capable of hosting PHP and MySQL databases to handle user management, donation records, and logistics tracking. This can be a cloud-based or shared hosting environment such as InfinityFree, equipped with necessary processing power and stable internet connectivity to ensure smooth communication between users, administrators, and delivery agents. Client devices like computers, smartphones, or tablets with internet access are essential for all user roles to interact with the platform through their web browsers.

For development and testing, a personal computer with sufficient specifications to run code editors (such as VS Code), local servers (like XAMPP), and database management tools is necessary. Overall, the hardware requirements focus on supporting seamless data exchange, secure storage, and multi-user access in an accessible and scalable manner.

Software Requirements

The software for the Food Waste Management System should include a secure web application developed using PHP and MySQL for backend processing and database management. It must support multiple user roles such as donors, administrators, and delivery agents, with distinct access rights and functionalities. The system should provide features for user authentication, donation registration, admin verification, task assignment, and real-time status updates. A user-friendly interface with clear navigation is vital to ensure accessibility for users with varying levels of technical expertise.

Additionally, the software should be compatible with major web browsers and accessible across devices such as desktops, tablets, and smartphones. It must ensure data security and privacy through encryption and secure communication protocols. The application is expected to handle concurrent users efficiently, with scalability to accommodate growth in user base and transaction volume. Integration with notification services (e.g., email or SMS alerts) will enhance communication and engagement among stakeholders, improving overall system responsiveness and reliability.

Chapter 4. Design

4.1 Architecture

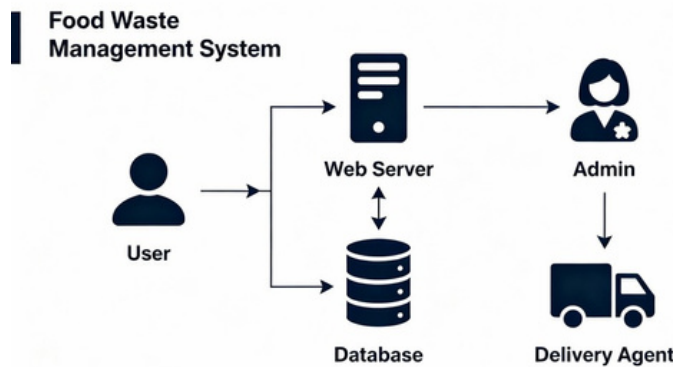


Fig. 4.1.1

The architecture of the Food Waste Management System is designed using a client-server model with a centralized web server and database. Users, including donors, administrators, and delivery agents, interact with the system through web browsers on various client devices. These clients send requests to the web server, which processes inputs such as login credentials, donation submissions, and delivery updates, and then responds with appropriate content and status information.

At the core of the system is a MySQL database that stores all critical data, including user profiles, donation records, delivery assignments, and transaction histories. The web server handles business logic, managing authentication and authorization to ensure secure access based on user roles. It also facilitates communication and data flow between different user types, enabling admins to verify donations and assign delivery tasks efficiently.

The system supports real-time status updates to keep all stakeholders informed throughout the donation and delivery cycle. Delivery agents update pickup and drop-off progress via their interface, which is immediately reflected in the database and visible to admins and donors. This interconnected design promotes transparency, accountability, and streamlined operations, enabling efficient redistribution of surplus food with minimal manual intervention.

4.2 Detailed Design

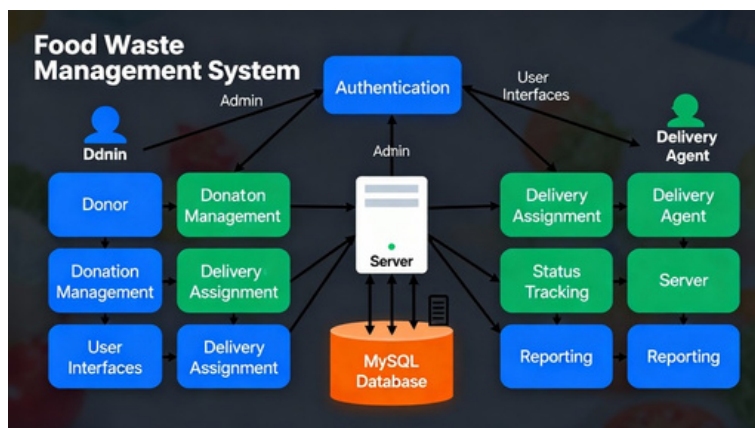


Fig. 4.2.1

The system is composed of three primary user interfaces: Donors, Admins, and Delivery Agents. Donors access the platform via web browsers to register surplus food donations by providing details such as food type, quantity, and pickup schedule. Admins manage the system by authenticating users, verifying donation requests, approving submissions, and assigning delivery tasks to agents. Delivery agents view their assigned pickups and drop-offs and update status information to keep the system current. The core functional modules include Authentication, Donation Management, Delivery Assignment, Status Tracking, and Reporting. The Authentication module handles secure user login and role-based access control, ensuring that donors, admins, and delivery agents have appropriate privileges. Donation Management allows donors to submit donation requests, which admins can review and approve. Delivery Assignment enables the admin to allocate pickup and delivery tasks to agents based on availability and location considerations. The system is composed of three primary user interfaces: Donors, Admins, and Delivery Agents. Donors access the platform via web browsers to register surplus food donations by providing details such as food type, quantity, and pickup schedule. Admins manage the system by authenticating users, verifying donation requests, approving submissions, and assigning delivery tasks to agents. Delivery agents view their assigned pickups and drop-offs and update status information to keep the system current.

A centralized MySQL database underpins the system, storing all user data, donation records, delivery schedules, and transaction history. The web server executes the business logic by processing requests from user interfaces, interacting with the database, and generating dynamic responses. Real-time updates are supported, allowing delivery agents to report status changes that reflect immediately on the donor’s and admin’s dashboards. Reporting tools help admins monitor system performance and generate summaries for decision-making. Overall, this design ensures organized workflows, transparency, and efficient food redistribution.

4.2.1 Use Case Diagram

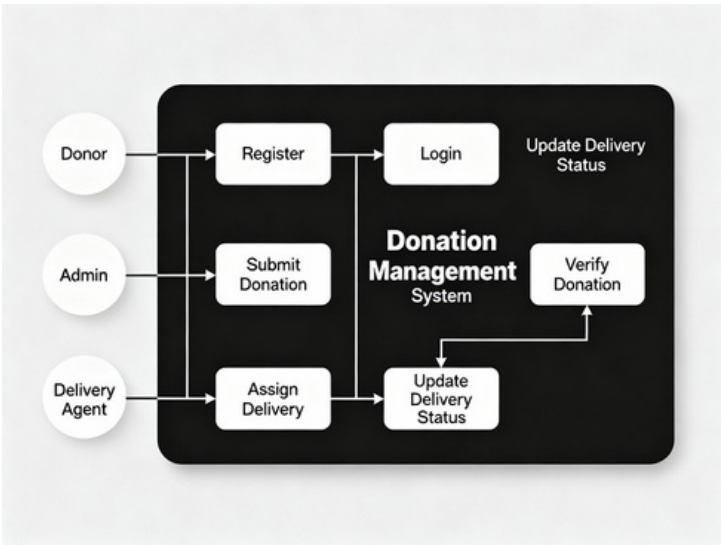


Fig. 4.2.1.1

The use case diagram visually represents the interactions between the primary actors—Donor, Admin, and Delivery Agent—and the Food Waste Management System. Donors can register and log in to the system, allowing them to submit surplus food donation requests. Admins have key responsibilities including verifying and approving donation submissions, managing user accounts, and assigning delivery tasks to agents. Delivery agents receive these assignments, update pickup and delivery statuses, and communicate progress back to the system. This diagram clearly outlines the core functionalities and workflows within the system, showcasing how different users perform their customized roles to collectively minimize food waste. It helps stakeholders understand system boundaries and key use scenarios efficiently, serving as a foundation for system development and testing.

4.2.2 Class Diagram

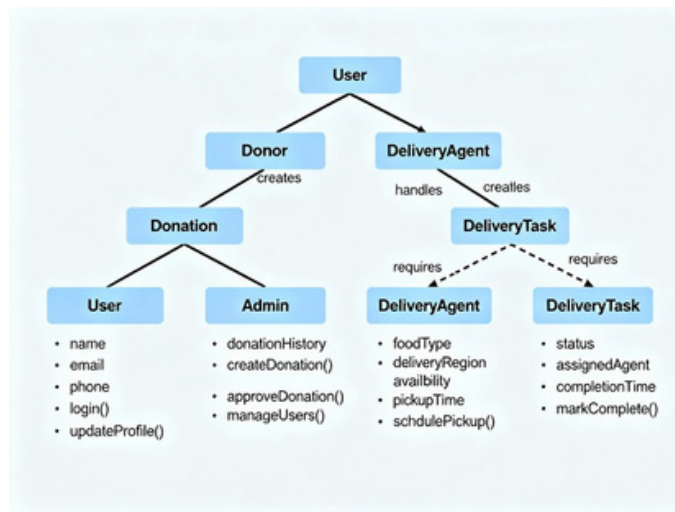


Fig. 4.2.2.1

The class diagram for the Food Waste Management System outlines the core components and their relationships within the system. At the highest level, there is a generic User class, which serves as a parent for specific roles such as Donor, Admin, and DeliveryAgent. Each subclass inherits common attributes like user ID, name, email, and password, and includes role-specific methods and functionalities. For instance, Donors can create and view food donations, Admins manage approvals, users, and generate reports, while DeliveryAgents handle assigned delivery tasks.

The Donation class represents the details of the surplus food offered by donors, including attributes such as food type, quantity, expiry date, and donation status. It is associated with one Donor and linked to corresponding DeliveryTasks for logistics tracking. The DeliveryTask class maintains information about delivery assignments, including statuses like pending, in-progress, or completed, and is tied to a specific DeliveryAgent and Donation. These classes reflect the lifecycle of a food donation, from creation through approval and delivery.

Together, the class diagram captures the static structure of the system, showing how data and responsibilities are distributed across the different entities. It provides a blueprint for implementing the backend logic, enabling secure user management, efficient handling of donations, and real-time tracking of deliveries. This organized design promotes modularity, maintainability, and clarity in the development process.

4.2.3 Sequence Diagram

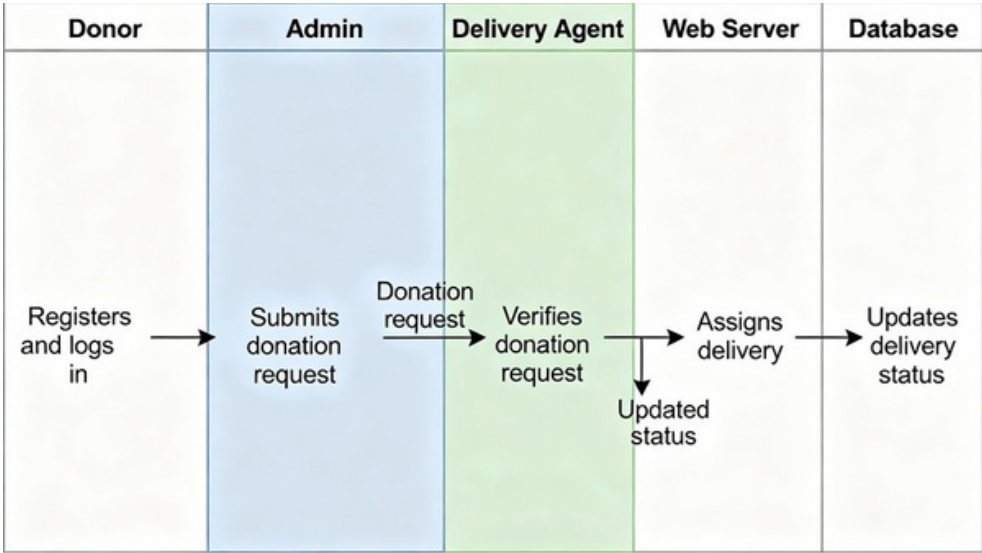


Fig. 4.2.3.1

The sequence diagram for the Food Waste Management System illustrates the step-by-step interaction among the major actors—Donor, Admin, Delivery Agent—and system components during the food donation process. It begins with the donor registering and logging into the system, which verifies credentials via the authentication module on the web server. After successful login, the donor submits a donation request, providing details about the food available for donation.

This request is received and stored in the centralized database. The admin then logs into the system to review and verify pending donation requests. Upon approval, the admin assigns delivery tasks to available delivery agents based on location and schedule. The delivery agent receives this task via their interface, picks up the food from the donor, updates the delivery status in the system, and finally completes the drop-off at the recipient location.

Throughout this process, the system ensures real-time updates by reflecting delivery statuses across dashboards accessible to donors and admins. The database records all transactions and state changes, enabling transparency, traceability, and accountability. This sequence navigation highlights the system’s focus on streamlined workflows and efficient food redistribution.

Chapter 5 Implementation

5.1 Flowchart



Fig 5.1.1

The flowchart diagram of the Food Waste Management System delineates the sequential steps involved in the process, from the moment a user logs in or registers to the completion of food donation distribution. It begins with user authentication, ensuring secure access for donors wishing to contribute surplus food. Once authenticated, donors submit details about the food available for donation, including type, quantity, and pickup location.

The submitted request is forwarded to the administrator, who reviews and verifies the donation details for suitability and compliance with safety standards. Upon approval, the administrator assigns a delivery agent to handle the pickup and delivery of the donated food. Delivery agents receive notifications of their tasks, proceed with collecting the food from donors, and deliver it to designated recipients such as NGOs or shelters.

Throughout this process, status updates are communicated back to the system, allowing real-time tracking and transparency for all parties involved. The flowchart emphasizes the system's goal to streamline food donation logistics, minimize delays, ensure accountability, and ultimately reduce food wastage by efficiently matching surplus food with those in need.

5.2 Implementation of the code

The frontend will be built using standard HTML5, CSS3 for styling, and JavaScript for dynamic interactions and form validations. The user interface will offer forms for donor registration, food donation submission, admin approval screens, and delivery agent status updates. It will use AJAX calls to interact asynchronously with the backend PHP scripts, enhancing user experience without full page reloads.

1. System Architecture

The system architecture of the Food Waste Management System is based on a classic LAMP-style stack, integrating client-side interfaces with server-side processing and backend database management. The frontend is developed with HTML, CSS, and JavaScript to create interactive and responsive user interfaces tailored for different user roles—donors, administrators, and delivery agents. Users interact with the system via web browsers or devices to submit donation requests, manage approvals, and update delivery statuses.

The architecture is divided into the following modules:

- Donation Module Database
- Management Module
- Analytics and Feedback Module

2. Frontend Implementation

The frontend implementation of your Food Waste Management System will utilize HTML for structuring the web pages, CSS for styling to ensure a clean, user-friendly interface, and JavaScript to add interactivity and dynamic content handling. The user interface will cater to multiple user roles like donors, admins, and delivery agents with dedicated pages and forms, such as registration/login screens, donation submission forms, approval panels, and delivery status update dashboards.

JavaScript will play a critical role in form validation, client-side data handling, and asynchronous communication with the backend PHP scripts via AJAX calls. This approach allows users to submit data and receive updates in real-time without having to refresh the whole page, enhancing the user experience. CSS frameworks or custom styles can be applied to create responsive layouts that work seamlessly across desktops, tablets, and mobile devices.

3. Backend Implementation

The backend implementation of your Food Waste Management System will be developed using PHP to handle all server-side logic, including user authentication, data validation, session management, and communication with the MySQL database. PHP scripts will manage CRUD (Create, Read, Update, Delete) operations for key entities like users, donations, delivery assignments, and status updates.

The backend will receive data inputs from the frontend via HTTP requests—such as login credentials, donation submissions, and status updates—validate and sanitize these inputs to ensure security and data integrity, and then execute SQL queries against the MySQL database to persist or retrieve information. Error handling and response generation will be included to inform the frontend about the success or failure of operations.

Role-based access control will restrict functionalities based on user roles (donor, admin, delivery agent), ensuring security and proper workflow enforcement. Additionally, the backend can generate reports for admins, send notifications, and integrate with external APIs if needed. This backend design ensures robust, secure, and efficient management of food donation workflows and data.

4. Database Implementation

The database implementation for your Food Waste Management System will utilize MySQL to store and manage all essential data. The database schema will include tables such as Users (with fields like user_id, name, email, password, role), Donations (donation_id, donor_id, food_type, quantity, donation_date, status), Delivery Assignments (assignment_id, donation_id, delivery_agent_id, pickup_time, delivery_time, status), and Status Updates to track real-time progress.

Relationships will be established through foreign keys; for example, Donations are linked to Users via donor_id, and DeliveryAssignments link donations to delivery agents. Indexing critical columns will optimize query performance. Data integrity constraints, such as NOT NULL, UNIQUE, and CHECK, will be enforced to maintain reliable data entry.

Stored procedures and triggers can be added for automating routine tasks like updating donation statuses or sending notifications. The database will be accessed securely through PHP backend scripts that perform validation and sanitize inputs to prevent SQL injection attacks. This structured and relational database design ensures efficient, consistent, and scalable data management tailored for the system's operational needs.

5. Analytics and Feedback Module

The analytics and feedback module in your Food Waste Management System will provide valuable insights into donation trends, user activity, and system performance, enabling data-driven decision making and continuous improvement. This module will aggregate data from donations, delivery completions, user registrations, and feedback forms stored in the database.

Analytics features will include graphical dashboards displaying metrics such as total donations over time, donation types and quantities, delivery efficiency, and user engagement statistics. Advanced filters and reports could help admins identify peak donation periods, underutilized resources, and areas for operational enhancement.

Algorithm

1. User Registration and Authentication:

- Accept user inputs for registration.
- Validate user details.
- Store user info with role (donor, admin, delivery agent).
- On login, verify credentials and start user session.

2. Donation Submission (Donor Role):

- Donor fills donation form with food details.
- Validate donation data.
- Store donation record with status 'Pending'.
- Notify admin of pending donation.

3. Donation Review and Approval (Admin Role):

- Admin views list of pending donations.
- Selects a donation to review.
- Approves or rejects donation.
- If approved, assign available delivery agent.
- Update donation status to 'Approved'.
- Notify delivery agent of assignment.

4. Delivery Task Management (Delivery Agent Role):

- Delivery agent views assigned tasks.
- Updates status during pickup, in transit, and delivery.
- At delivery confirmation, update donation and task status to 'Completed'.

5. Analytics and Reporting:

- Collect data on donations, deliveries, and users.
- Generate summary statistics: total donations, completed, pending, delivery times.
- Present reports to admins.

6. Feedback Collection:

- Allow users to submit feedback.
- Store feedback for admin review and system improvements.

7. Logout:

- Terminate user session.

Chapter 6 Testing

6.1 Different steps of Testing

1. Unit Testing

- Test user registration function with valid and invalid inputs.
- Test login authentication with correct and incorrect credentials.
- Test donation submission form validation and data insertion.
- Test admin approval logic, including donation status updates.

2. Integration Testing

- Test user registration integrated with login and profile management.
- Test donation submission flow from donor frontend to database and admin notification.
- Test admin approval process tied with delivery agent assignment and notification.
- Test delivery updates reflected in donation status and available for donor/admin view.

3. Functional Testing

- Verify whole donation lifecycle: registration → donation submission → approval → delivery → completion.
- Confirm role-based access controls for donors, admins, and delivery agents.
- Test multi-user access scenarios, concurrent donations, and updates.

4. Performance Testing

This step checks the website's speed, responsiveness, and stability under different loads. It ensures that AI responses, page loading, and content saving happen efficiently, even with multiple users accessing the system simultaneously.

5. Security Testing

User authentication, API key handling, and data storage are tested for security vulnerabilities. This includes checking protection against unauthorized access, data leaks, and injection attacks.

6. Usability Testing

Real users or testers interact with the platform to ensure it is easy to navigate, visually clear, and user- friendly. Feedback from this step helps refine the UI/UX design.

7. Compatibility Testing

The website is tested across different devices, browsers, and screen sizes to ensure consistent performance and appearance everywhere.

8. System Testing

All components are tested together in a real-world environment to confirm that the system functions as a complete, integrated solution without errors.

9. Acceptance Testing

In this phase, the system is tested from an end-user perspective by verifying core workflows such as donor registration, food donation posting, admin approval, NGO selection, and delivery assignment. Acceptance testing confirms that the system works correctly across all modules (User, Admin, and Delivery Person) Successful acceptance testing indicates that the project is ready for deployment and practical use in reducing food wastage.

6.2 Test Cases

Test Case 1: Invalid Login Credentials

Input: User enters incorrect email or password.

Expected Result: Display message “Invalid email or password. Please try again.”

Test Case 2: Empty Food Donation Details

Input: Donor tries to submit a food donation form without entering food type or quantity.

Expected Result: Display message “Food details cannot be empty.”

Test Case 3: Donation Request Submission Failure

Input: User submits a donation request but the server fails or database connection is lost.

Expected Result: Display message “Donation request failed. Please try again later.”

Test Case 4: Invalid Quantity Input

Input: Donor enters non-numeric or zero value in the food quantity field.

Expected Result: Display message “Please enter a valid food quantity.”

Test Case 5: Unauthorized Access to Admin Panel

Input: Normal user tries to access the admin dashboard URL directly.

Expected Result: Display message “Unauthorized access. Admin login required.”

Test Case 6: Successful Donation Matching

Input: Admin views available donations submitted by nearby donors.

Expected Result: System displays relevant donation details for pickup and distribution.

Test Case 7: Invalid Pickup Assignment

Input: Admin assigns a delivery person who is not registered or inactive.

Expected Result: Display message “Invalid delivery person selection.”

Test Case 8: Network/Server Error

Input: User tries to load the application during a server outage.

Expected Result: Display message “Server unavailable. Please try again later.”

Test Case 9: Donation Search Function

Input: Admin searches for donations with criteria that do not exist.

Expected Result: Display message “No donations found for the selected criteria.”

Test Case 10: Food Image Upload Preview

Input: Donor uploads an image of the food while submitting the donation form.

Expected Result: System successfully uploads the image and displays it for preview before final submission.

Chapter 7: Results and Discussions

7.1 Snapshots

- Login page



Fig. 7.1.1

The home page introduces the Food Waste Management System with a clean and user-friendly design, encouraging users to reduce food wastage by donating excess food. It features easy navigation links, login and registration options, and clear call-to-action buttons for donating food or requesting assistance, helping users quickly understand and use the system.

- User login page

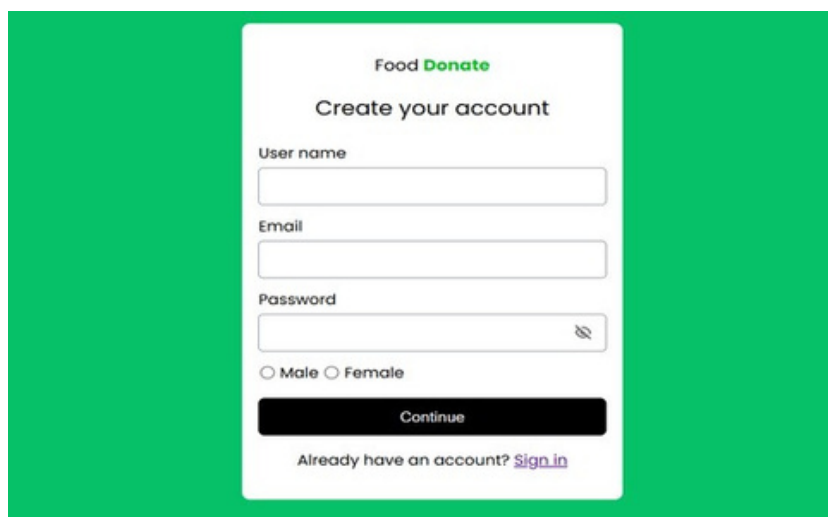


Fig. 7.1.2

The sign-up page allows new users to create an account by entering details such as name, email, and password. It serves as the registration screen that enables users to access the features of the Food Waste Management System, including donating food, managing requests, and tracking deliveries.

- Admin page

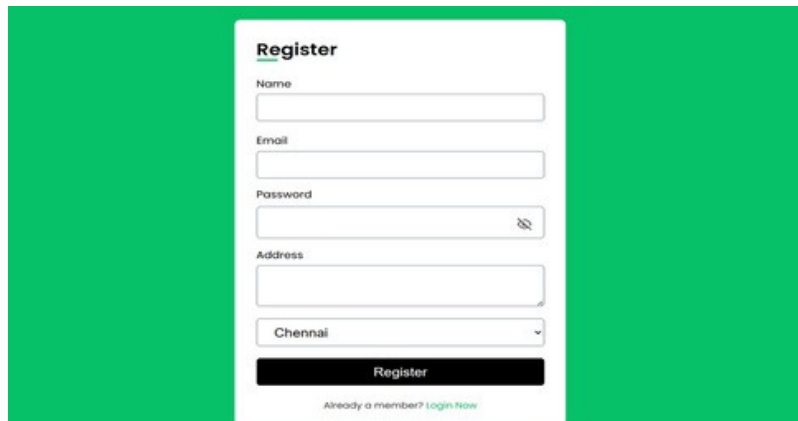
A registration form titled "Register" is centered on a solid green background. The form contains five input fields: "Name", "Email", "Password" (with a toggle icon), "Address", and a dropdown menu currently showing "Chennai". Below these fields is a black "Register" button. At the bottom of the form, there is a link that says "Already a member? Login Now".

Fig.7.1.3

The login page allows users to sign in using their email and password. It features a clean and modern layout with an image on one side and the login form on the other, providing secure access to the Food Waste Management System for donors, admins, and delivery personnel.

- Home page

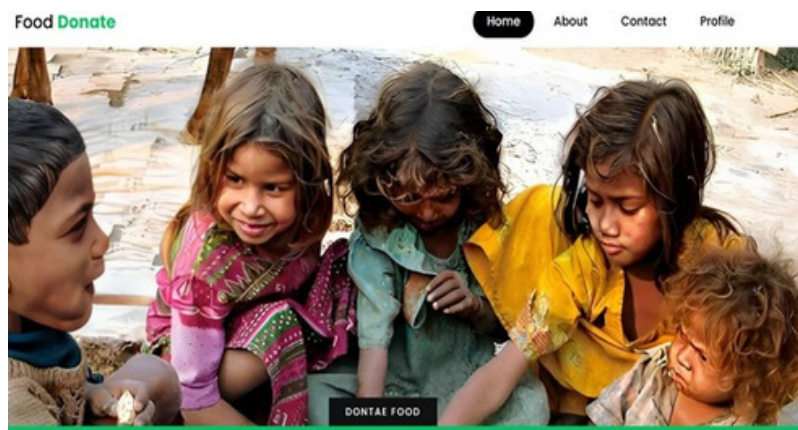


Fig.7.1.4

The profile page displays user details like name, email, and bio, along with profile picture and social links. It also includes an “Edit Profile” option for updating personal information easily.

- About us



Fig.7.1.5

This image displays the Food Donation Details page of the Food Waste Management System, where donors can create or update a food donation request. It includes fields for food type, quantity, pickup location, and expiry time, along with options to upload food images and submit the donation for further processing.

▪ **Contact us**

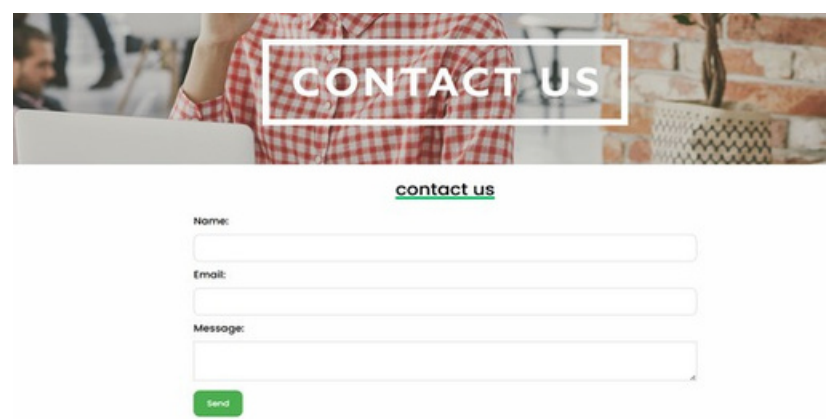
The image shows a 'CONTACT US' banner with a background of people working. Below the banner is a form titled 'contact us' with fields for 'Name:', 'Email:', and 'Message:'. A green 'Send' button is at the bottom.

Fig.7.1.6

▪ **Admin register**

The image shows a 'Register' form on a green background. The form has fields for 'Name', 'Email', 'Password', and 'Address'. There is a dropdown menu for 'Madurai' and a 'Register' button. A link 'Already a member? Login now' is at the bottom.

Fig.7.1.7

This page stores and manages all the juicy data behind the scenes, keeping everything neat and easy to fetch.It’s basically the brain of the whole system—organized, efficient, and lowkey a data wizard

- **Delivery reg**

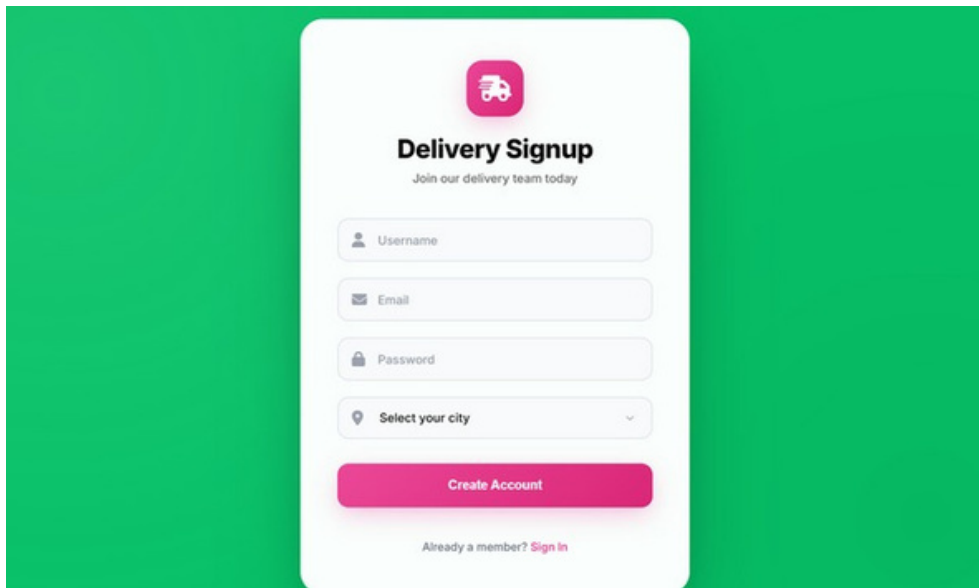
A mobile app interface for a delivery signup form. The background is a solid green color. In the center is a white rounded rectangle containing the form. At the top of the white rectangle is a pink square icon with a white delivery truck. Below the icon is the title "Delivery Signup" in bold black text, followed by the subtitle "Join our delivery team today" in a smaller black font. The form consists of four input fields: "Username" with a person icon, "Email" with an envelope icon, "Password" with a lock icon, and "Select your city" with a location pin icon and a dropdown arrow. Below these fields is a large pink button labeled "Create Account". At the bottom of the white rectangle, there is a link that says "Already a member? Sign In" in a small, light pink font.

Fig.7.1.8

This enables delivery staff to access their dashboard immediately, view assigned pickups, and manage deliveries efficiently, ensuring smooth coordination within the food donation system.

Chapter 8. Conclusions and Scope for Future Work

8.1 Conclusion

The development of the Food Waste Management System successfully demonstrates the effective use of modern web technologies to address the critical issue of food wastage. By integrating a user-friendly web interface with a robust backend using PHP and MySQL, the system provides a reliable platform that connects food donors, NGOs/administrators, and delivery personnel in a coordinated manner. The application streamlines the entire process of food donation — from donor registration and food listing to admin management and delivery assignment — ensuring that excess food reaches those in need efficiently.

The project reduces manual coordination, minimizes food spoilage, and promotes social responsibility by making food donation simple and accessible. Features such as secure authentication, donation tracking, role-based access, and responsive design enhance usability and system reliability. Overall, the successful implementation of this project highlights how technology can play a vital role in solving real-world social problems and contributes meaningfully toward sustainable food management and community welfare.

8.2 Future Scope

The Food Waste Management System has strong potential for future enhancements to make it more intelligent, scalable, and impactful. One important upgrade could be the integration of machine learning-based recommendation systems to analyse donation patterns and user behaviour, helping suggest optimal pickup times, nearby NGOs, or high-demand food types. This would improve efficiency and reduce food wastage further. Additionally, cloud deployment and scalability improvements would allow the system to handle a growing number of users, donations, and real-time requests with better performance and reliability.

Another promising direction is the use of AI-powered features such as demand forecasting to predict food requirements in different locations and seasons, as well as automated routing for delivery personnel to minimize time and fuel consumption. The system could also support multilingual interfaces to increase accessibility and reach a wider user base. Features like real-time notifications, mobile app integration, and analytics dashboards for NGOs and administrators would enhance usability and decision-making. With these advancements, the Food Waste Management System can evolve into a smart, scalable, and socially impactful platform that significantly contributes to sustainable food distribution and community welfare.

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Appendices

Appendix A – Source Code

This appendix contains the core source code files used in the development of the Food Waste Management System. It covers both the frontend and backend components, including:

- Frontend (HTML, CSS, JavaScript): User interface for Login, Signup, Donation Form, and Dashboard pages.
- Backend (PHP): Scripts for user authentication, donation management, admin controls, and delivery assignment.
- Database Connectivity: Files for connecting to the MySQL database, executing queries, and handling CRUD operations.

The source code ensures smooth interaction between users, admin, and delivery personnel while maintaining data integrity.

Appendix B – System Requirements

Software Requirements:

- Web Server: XAMPP / WAMP / LAMP
- PHP 7.0+
- MySQL 5.7+
- Web Browser: Chrome, Firefox, Edge

Hardware Requirements:

- Minimum 8 GB RAM
- Intel i5 Processor or above
- 256 GB SSD or higher

Operating System:

- Windows / Linux / macOS

Development Tools:

- VS Code (IDE)
- phpMyAdmin (Database Management)
- Web Browser for testing

Libraries/Technologies Used:

- PHP, MySQL
- HTML, CSS, JavaScript
- Bootstrap for responsive UI design

Appendix C – Sample Screenshots

This appendix provides visual references for the main modules of the system:

1. Login Page: Secure login for Donors, Admins, and Delivery Personnel.
2. Signup Page: User registration with name, email, and password fields.
3. Food Donation Form: Input fields for food type, quantity, pickup location, and image upload.
4. Admin Dashboard: View and manage donation requests and assign deliveries.
5. Delivery Dashboard: Track assigned pickups and drop-offs.

Screenshots demonstrate the usability and design of the system's interface.

Appendix D – Test Results

This appendix includes detailed test case reports covering the following:

- Unit and Integration Testing: Testing individual modules and their interactions (Login, Signup, Donation Form, Admin and Delivery Dashboards).
- Functional and Performance Testing: Ensuring all features work as intended under normal and peak load conditions.
- Security and Usability Testing: Verifying secure authentication, role-based access, and user-friendly interface.

Appendix E – References

Lists all resources, frameworks, APIs, and documentation used during the development of the Food Waste Management System:

- PHP Documentation
- MySQL Documentation
- HTML, CSS, and JavaScript Guides
- Bootstrap Documentation
- VS Code Documentation
- XAMPP Documentation
- GitHub Repositories and Open-Source Projects
- Web Development Tutorials and Blogs